

What do you do when AI bros make the "water cycle" argument when we say that AI wastes water?

Posted by u/Medical_Deal5272 • • 0 points • 54 comments

I'm curious as to know the counter argument for this as someone who isn't as educated on this subject.

Comments

u/Critical_Dmg • 1 points • 2026-03-18 02:36 UTC

You're both wrong.

Just because water comes back to earth doesn't mean it's usable.

But also AI doesn't use nearly as much as rage bait would have you believe. So not a particularly valuable point to be made. Direct to chip uses very little. Air assist doesn't use a tremendous amount. The only cooling style that really uses a lot is pure evap.

u/Traditional-Car5655 • 1 points • 2026-03-16 04:53 UTC

Interesting thread. You are asking others to make an argument for you? Don't be sheep, make your own opinion and then internally make an argument why you believe in it. Don't let others form your opinion

u/marshallspight • 1 points • 2026-03-15 02:01 UTC

I would propose that there are good reasons to be concerned about AI. Fraud/deepfakes is one. Job loss is another.

The argument about AI consuming resources is pretty weak, and especially weak since AI is just one of many types of computing, which itself is just one of many types of commercial/industrial uses of water or electricity. If the real issue was consumption of resources, we would expect to see some kind of balanced argument about what industries are using the most water and some kind of per-industry cost/benefit analysis.

Repeatedly putting water usage front and center in the AI discussion is, I believe, a mistake.